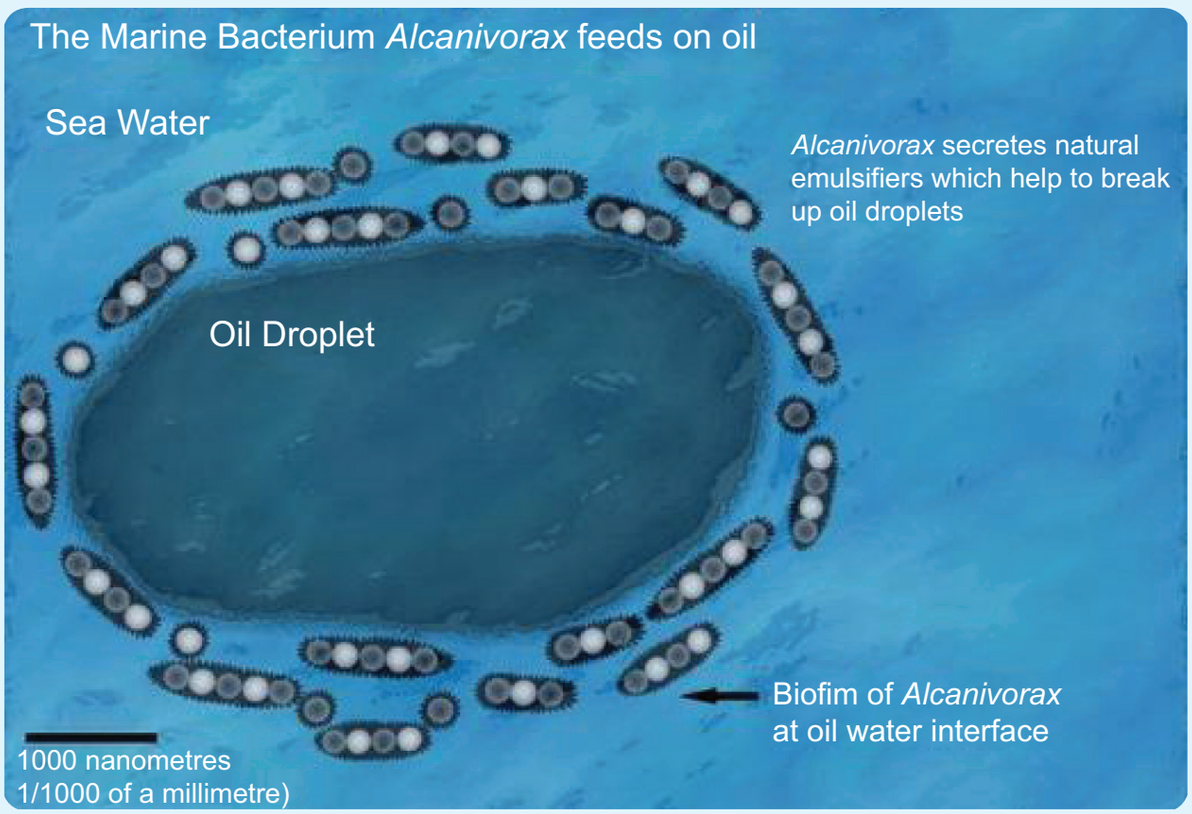
Infobits

Microbes at work:

One of the major environmental problems today is hydrocarbon contamination resulting from the activities related to the Petrochemical Iindustry. Accidental releases of petroleum products are of particular concern in the environment. Hydrocarbon components have been known to belong to the family of carcinogens and neurotoxic organic pollutants. Petroleum-based products are the major source of energy for industry and daily life. Leaks and accidental spills occur regularly during the exploration, production, refining, transport, and storage of petroleum and petroleum products. There are the two main approaches to oil spill bioremediation: (a) Bioaugmentation, in which known oil-degrading bacteria are added to supplement the existing microbial population, and (b) Biostimulation, in which the growth of indigenous oil degraders is stimulated by the addition of nutrients or other growth-limiting cosubstrates. Bacteria like *Pseudomonas putida* and *Alcanivorax borkumens* are the most active agents in petroleum degradation, and they work as primary degraders of spilled oil in environment. Bioremediation is a potential source for clean and green environment.



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